1.4 Comparison of Numbers

We are familiar with the concept of comparing numbers and finding the biggest among them. We use symbols <, > and = to compare any two numbers.

1.4.1 Comparing numbers with unequal number of digits

1. When we compare the numbers 16090 and 100616, we have already learnt that the number with more digits is greater.

   Hence, 1,00,616 (6 digit number) > 16,090 (5 digit number).

TRY THESE

1. Write the numbers in the ascending order: 688, 9, 23005, 50, 7500.
2. Find the least and the greatest among the numbers: 478, 98, 6348, 3, 6007, 50935.

2. Suppose we are given more than two numbers say 1468, 5, 201, 69 and 70000. Then among these, we can immediately say that the number 70000 is the greatest and 5 is the least, based on the number of digits.

1.4.2 Comparing numbers with equal number of digits

Think about the situation

In a distance analysis chart, the distance between Chennai and New Delhi is 2180 k.m. and Chennai to Noida is 2158 k.m. respectively. Which city is farther from Chennai?

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	
Compare the thousands place of two numbers 2 1 8 0 2 1 5 8 Here digit at the thousands place of both numbers are the same. We can't arrive at any conclusion. So, we move on to the next step.	Compare the hundreds place of two numbers 2 1 8 0 2 1 5 8 Here digit at the hundreds place of both numbers are the same. We can't arrive at any conclusion. So, we move on to the next step.	Compare the tens place of two numbers 2 1 8 0 2 1 5 8 Here digit at the tens place of both numbers are different, So, the number with the greatest tenth place will be the greater. Therefore, 2180 > 2158	Think! Why we need not compare the one's place?

Compare the given numbers 2180 and 2158 using the above mentioned steps.

2 = 2	1 = 1	8 > 5

Hence, 2180 > 2158. So, New Delhi is farther from chennai.

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